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MY POWAI

Volume No. 13 Issue No. 02 Mumbai October 2024



Dear friends

This October issue of My Powai comes alive with the vibrant spirit of festivals! The recent Ganpati celebrations were a grand success, with Powai coming together in a beautiful display of devotion and community spirit. We've captured the essence of the festivities in our inside pages—be sure to relive the moments through our detailed coverage.

As we move from one festival to another, Powai is now preparing for the lively Navratri celebrations. Dandiya nights are on everyone's calendar, and we hope the rains will give us a break to enjoy the colorful evenings without interruptions!

With seasonal changes and the rise in viral infections, our in-house Nutritionist has penned a must-read article on immunity-boosting foods. This is valuable advice for everyone, regardless of age, as staying healthy is a priority during these times. For the festive season, Chef Ashwini Pai has crafted some special dishes you can enjoy with your family.

And for those curious about what the stars have in store, our astrologer brings you detailed predictions for each zodiac sign—whether it's love, career, or personal growth, there's something to look forward to!

Local news and updates are also packed into this issue, keeping you informed about everything happening in and around Powai. We always welcome your suggestions and feedback, so feel free to share your thoughts with us. Enjoy the festive season and happy reading!

Mahesh Kutty
(Editor)

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The open lands in are being filled for rehousing projects.



D.P.K. Udas

Recently there has been news that Salt Pans at Kanjur shall have buildings to house displaced people from Dharavi. These people are not original owners but shall be given this place on rent.

As such if Dharavi Slum is getting developed then like other SRA schemes they can create temporary shelters on that plot of land itself and then after making new buildings shift them there. Where is the need to shift them elsewhere?

The piece of land at Kanjur is 256 acres. It is green area and fresh breath of air on entire Eastern Express Highway.

The transfer of land is being done by Central Government to State Government. Earlier State Government had requested for small portion of this land for Metro Shed. This could have avoided cutting of trees at Aarey. However, at that time it was denied. Now the land parcel is transferred to the State Government so that same can be transferred to Adani Reality.

The original land was leased by the Government to following Salt Pan companies.
Arthur Salt Works – 120.5 acres
Jenkins Salt Works – 58.5 acres
Jamasp Salt Works – 58.5 acres
Suleman Salt Works – 28 acres

Now this lease is over and Government is taking over possession of the same.
There was other news that Dharavi residents will be housed at Railway Colony at Matunga. However there has been strong opposition from locals in Matunga and that proposal is on hold.

However, Powai and area around is soft target and many decision makers are taking this opportunity.

Another example is Sangharsh Nagar at Chandivali. This parcel of land at foothills of Powai Mountains was de-reserved and used to house slum dwellers from Sanjay Gandhi National Park.



They were given pucca houses here. However, these residents had their work places in and around Borivali. They chose to go there by selling places here.

Now what is the guarantee that Dharavi residents will stay at Kanjur?
It is also said that these tenements are for those who are not eligible for ownership houses in Dharavi. They would be given these houses on rent. Now in Mumbai there are many tenants who have become owners. Ultimately these displaced people are here to stay. Also houses will be sold and new slum will come up elsewhere.

The open lands in Powai have been taken over by MHADA and houses built on the same.

Powai is the suburb which remained green for long time. The development took place elsewhere in Mumbai particularly in and around railway line. Another challenge in Powai was hilly terrain. However Private Developers have found the way around by levelling existing hills. The plot where Raheja Nest buildings are standing today was a hill once. Even Raheja Vihar is standing on razed hills.

The Government of Maharashtra wants Mumbai to be free of slums. They want to build 4 lac houses for the same. MHADA/MMRDA/CIDCO together will drive this project. They are scouting for the land pieces and hopefully they will find places away from Powai.

(The author is long time resident of Powai. He takes up civic issues with the authorities. He has been instrumental in improving illumination in the area, zebra crossings , garbage removal etc.)



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Skin care in Acne

ACNE is a common skin ailment seen in teenagers during adolescence.

There are 6 types of Acne:
1. Papules 2. Blackheads. 3. Whiteheads.
4. Pustules 5. Nodules. 6. Cysts.

DO's for Acne

1. Watch your Diet – A poor diet will just increase you acne, so limit sugar and carb intake and drink plenty of water.
2. Wash your face – Your skin is sensitive, so make sure not to overdo this. Washing you face twice should be more than enough.
3. Moisturize – Acne is often caused by dry skin, so hydrating can help balance and control acne.
4. Use Ice – Ice applied for short time periods can help reduce acne swelling.

DON'TS FOR ACNE

1. Stay out of the Sun – Too much time in the sun can dry up your acne, putting you at risks for skin damage. So it is better to use acne friendly sunscreens in gel base.
2. Don't Scratch – Scratching will only increase the spread of infection and damage your skin.
3. Care with Cosmetics Usage – Take care which cosmetics you use for face because they can block pores, resulting in more acne.
4. Don't Over Examine – Avoid touching with your fingers. This may be hard, but try not to let it bother you. No ones skin looks perfect under the spotlight.

Skin care in Fungal infections

This is a common skin disorder seen in summer time and in sweaty areas.

CARE DURING FUNGAL INFECTIONS

PERSONAL HYGIENE

1. Keep the affected areas clean and dry.
-2. Avoid scratching the infected areas.

CLOTHING HYGIENE

1. Wear loose cotton clothes to reduce sweating.
2. Change all your clothes daily and bed linen regularly and wash in hot water.
3. Sun dry and iron the clothes inside out before wearing.
4. Don't share clothes, footwears and beddings with others.

TREATMENT

1 Complete the treatment given by Dermatologist timely even if itching is relieved.
2 The antifungal creams should be applied 2cm beyond the margin of the lesion and for at least 2 weeks beyond complete healing of lesions.
3 Do not self medicate without consulting with the doctor.

CAUTION

1. Do not ignore symptoms like weight loss, loss of appetite, severe hair loss, etc

CARE FOR OTHERS

1. Wash your clothes separately in case of washing machine use after soaking in hot water. This prevents the fungus from passing to the clothes of other family members.
2. Better to avoid swimming pools and water parks, till complete relief from the infection.

Dr. Sanjay Fernandes. (MD, DNB, DDV) is a Consultant Dermatologist at Holy Spirit Hospital, Andheri East and at Sanjeevani Diagnostic Centre, Opp IIT Main Gate, Powai. Mobile - 9820206965.



Celebration of Ganpati festival with differance at Panch Smruti



The Ganpati festival at Panch Smruti this year was a remarkable five-day celebration, highlighted by the enthusiastic participation of underprivileged children from the local Anganwadi. Around 120 children joined the festivities, singing devotional songs, reciting poems, and enjoying the divine Ganpati Darshan alongside the residents of Panch Smruti. Their joy and energy brought a special warmth to the event, symbolizing unity and inclusivity.

A key feature of this festival was the daily preparation of prasadam by the women of Panch Smruti. Every evening, they lovingly cooked and served prasadam to all the devotees, fostering a spirit of community and hospitality. This added a personal touch to the celebrations, with food becoming a means of connecting people and enhancing the devotion to Lord Ganesh.

The festival also celebrated unity in diversity, as residents from various backgrounds came together in harmony to worship and partake in the festivities. Special attention was given to maintaining eco-friendly practices throughout the event, ensuring that the Ganpati idol and all decorations were environmentally sustainable, aligning with the growing emphasis on green and responsible celebrations.

The combination of spiritual devotion, community bonding, and eco-consciousness made this Ganpati festival at Panch Smruti a truly memorable and meaningful celebration for all.



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"Our core philosophy is to inspire students to truly love learning."

- Tanmay



Pratik Sonone
Cofounder Axios Career Academy



Tanmay Malik
Cofounder Axios Career Academy

Pratik and Tanmay, both IIT alumni, chose to forgo lucrative careers and opportunities abroad to pursue their true passion—teaching. Based in Chandivali, AXIOS, their coaching class has become a go-to destination for aspiring students. In a candid conversation with My Powai, they share their journey, challenges and the joy of shaping young minds. Here are the highlights.

Can you both share a bit about your backgrounds and what led you to this path in education?

Pratik: I grew up in a small town called Amravati in Maharashtra, where my father worked at a bank. Coming from a middle-class family, education and hard work were the values my parents ingrained in me from a young age. My father often reminded us that 'Education is the only capital you have,' which became a guiding principle in my life.

Despite limited resources and access to quality teachers in Amravati, I prepared for the JEE entrance exams with determination. I understand firsthand the crucial role that a good teacher can play in shaping a student's success. In 2011, I cracked the JEE and earned a place at IIT Bombay, where I pursued a B.Tech in Metallurgical Engineering and Material Science.

During my time at IIT, I discovered my passion for teaching. While completing my degree, I began coaching students for the IIT JEE entrance exams. It was incredibly fulfilling to help students grasp difficult concepts, especially in Math. That sense of achievement—both mine and theirs—sparked a love for teaching that has stayed with me ever since."

Tanmay:I come from a small town of Saharanpur in UP. Growing up, I was always a problem solver, and that natural inclination led me to pursue engineering. I moved to Kota, Rajasthan, to prepare for the JEE entrance exams, and it was there that I realized the profound impact a good teacher can have on their pupils.

In 2012, I secured a place at IIT Bombay to pursue a dual degree in Metallurgical Engineering and Materials Science. During my time at IIT, I was part of the National Service Scheme (NSS) educational outreach program, where I taught underprivileged students in Phule Nagar. That experience was incredibly fulfilling and played a significant role in inspiring me to pursue teaching as a career.

In addition, I served as a teaching assistant for undergraduate students at IIT, which gave me further insight into the power of education and the joy of helping students overcome academic challenges."

Both of you are IIT alumni, which opens doors to lucrative job opportunities abroad. What motivated you to choose teaching as your career?

Pratik: I started my career in fintech, but it didn't take long before I realized that the typical office routine wasn't fulfilling for me. I remember constantly feeling dissatisfied working with Excel sheets all day. After about 8 months, I decided to quit my job and explore other opportunities.

We'd always been interested in startups, particularly in the rooftop solar space, but the timing wasn't right—especially with the economic challenges following demonetization in 2016. Many of our friends' startups were closing down, so we started tutoring students for the IIT JEE just to make ends meet while we figured out our next move.

It was during this time that we noticed a huge gap in coaching for international curriculums like IB and IGCSE. These programs were a refreshing contrast to the rat race of JEE preparation, allowing students to choose their subjects and difficulty levels. They encouraged real learning and understanding, especially for students interested in STEM subjects.

That's when we decided to pivot and focus on providing specialized services for students in international curriculums. It felt like the right move, combining our passion for education with the opportunity to bring something valuable to the market."



How does Axios differentiate itself from other coaching centers, and what unique teaching methods or approaches do you implement?

Tanmay: At Axios, our core philosophy is to inspire students to truly love learning. We move away from rote memorization and focus instead on teaching concepts through proofs and derivations. This approach encourages students to understand the 'why' behind what they're learning, which fosters deeper intellectual curiosity and long-term retention.

We maintain a nurturing environment where students feel safe and supported—there's no hitting, no passive-aggressive behavior, and no pressure to conform to outdated teaching methods. Instead, we aim to inspire confidence and growth by treating every student with respect.

One of the unique features of Axios is our fully functional laboratory, which is specifically designed for Paper 6 (ATP) of IGCSE and AS level science. We are the only coaching center to offer such a facility, allowing students to gain hands-on experience in scientific experimentation,

(contd from Page 6)

which is critical for their understanding of real-world applications.

Additionally, **we provide a dedicated library space to encourage self-learning.** This gives students a quiet and resource-rich environment where they can explore subjects on their own and develop independent learning skills.

We've also built our infrastructure to support learning, taking inspiration from the principles outlined in *Atomic Habits*. Every aspect of our environment is designed to foster positive study habits, from the layout of our classrooms to the availability of resources like books and technology.

And, of course, we believe that comfort matters too. That's why we offer free coffee for students—a small gesture to make the learning experience a bit more enjoyable and keep them energized during their study sessions.

Can you share a success story from your time at Axios that exemplifies the impact your coaching has had on a student's academic journey?

Tanmay: At Axios, one of the most rewarding parts of our work is seeing the impact we have on students' academic journeys, especially when we ignite a passion for STEM. One standout success story involves a student who joined us in grade 10 and stayed with us through grade 12. When he first came to us, he was a bright kid but had a deep fear of Math. Through our approach of always asking 'why' and focusing on the concepts behind the problems, we were able to build his confidence and interest in the subject. He was so inspired that he chose Applied Mathematics for his bachelor's degree. Today, he works for BlackRock in the U.S., which is an incredible achievement.

In general, our students have seen significant improvements, with their grades increasing by an average of two grade points. Since our inception in 2020, many of our students have secured admissions to prestigious universities like Cornell, Imperial College, University of Cambridge, UC Berkeley, UCL, and many more. We're expecting even more amazing results in the coming years, as our students continue to excel.

W**hat challenges have you faced in running a coaching class for school students, and how have you overcome them to ensure high-quality education?**

Pratik: One of the major challenges we've faced is finding qualified teachers who are not only strong in their core subject but also proficient in English. The pool of such candidates is quite small, and it's crucial that they can communicate effectively with students, especially given that we primarily focus on international curriculums.

Another significant challenge has been training teachers to shed the 'CBSE mentality' and unlearn habits ingrained by Indian curriculums. Many teachers are accustomed to approaches that discourage the use of technology, such as calculators or tools like ChatGPT, which are integral in international curriculums. Shifting their mindset towards embracing these technologies and teaching methods takes time and effort. While the process is tedious, we are one of the few institutions that invest heavily in guiding our educators through this transformation to ensure high-quality education.

Additionally, we've faced challenges in supporting students with learning disabilities such as dyslexia, dysgraphia, or dyscalculia. Post-pandemic, we've also seen an increase in exam anxiety and attention deficit issues. To help students overcome these challenges, we introduced our '30 days 30 Tests' initiative. Before board exams, students take a test every day at the same hour as their final exam. This routine helps them build familiarity with exam conditions, easing their anxiety and boosting their confidence."



In the era of online education, how is Axios adapting to the digital shift, and what role do you see technology playing in the future of your coaching classes?

Tanmay: At Axios, we've embraced the digital shift by expanding our services to offer online coaching for students not just locally, but across the globe, including regions like the UK, Singapore, Hong Kong, and the Middle East. We've made significant investments in our online infrastructure to ensure that the quality of education remains consistent, whether delivered in person or virtually. Our online setup allows us to engage students just as effectively as we do in our physical classrooms, making sure learning is interactive and personalized.

Looking ahead, we're working on integrating AI into our platform to enhance student practice. While AI won't replace the role of the teacher, it will certainly assist by providing targeted practice, real-time feedback, and tailored learning experiences. We see AI as a powerful tool that complements our teaching, giving students more opportunities to practice concepts on their own.

Additionally, we're developing in-house content to further support this AI-driven practice, ensuring it aligns with our teaching philosophy. For our classroom programs, we've also implemented systems to digitize lessons, allowing students to revisit concepts anytime. This hybrid approach guarantees that learning continues beyond the classroom, adapting to each student's pace and needs.

What are your long-term goals for Axios, and how do you plan to continue evolving the program to meet the changing needs of students and the education system?

Pratik: At Axios, we've made a conscious decision to keep our operation boutique, with no immediate plans for large-scale expansion. This allows us to focus on delivering a high-quality, personalized learning experience. However, we are expanding our online services to meet growing demand, particularly for students in international markets. We're actively training a cohort of teachers to support this expansion, ensuring that our online offerings maintain the same level of excellence as our in-person coaching.

One of our primary long-term goals is to develop an online practice platform tailored to the needs of both students and teachers. Existing platforms like Kerboodle or Kognity often fall short—they are not user-friendly, and instead of saving teachers time, they add more work. Our platform aims to solve this problem by providing a seamless, intuitive experience that supports both independent student practice and teacher facilitation.

We're targeting a mid-2025 launch for this platform and are confident it will address the gaps in current educational technologies, ultimately enhancing the learning process for students and making life easier for teachers.

Badminton Tournament at Maple Leaf Society: A Thrilling Success



The Maple Leaf Society in Raheja Vihar hosted an exciting badminton tournament on September 21st and 22nd, 2024. This two-day event brought together enthusiastic players from the community, fostering camaraderie and sportsmanship.



Organizers and Core Committee
The tournament was spearheaded by three dedicated members: Melwyn, Siddhant, and Blasius. Their leadership, along with the support of the core committee members—Sushant, Ashish, Raj, Anil, Neeraj, James, Sudip, Ratnesh, Vipul, Kalpana, Anagha, Vedika, and Bhakti - ensured that the event was a resounding success. Their hard work and planning paid off, creating an engaging atmosphere for participants and spectators alike.

Ceremonies and Coverage
The event kicked off with an inspiring opening ceremony led by Mr. and Mrs. Nair, who set a positive tone for the tournament. James provided excellent photography services, capturing the vibrant moments of the tournament, while Minnisha beautifully documented the highlights, ensuring that memories were preserved for years to come.

The closing ceremony was equally commendable, with remarks and presentations made by our society's official committee members, including Mrs. Kukreja, Mr. Summit, Mr. Nikhil, Mr. Anshum and Mr. Amit, who celebrated the spirit of sportsmanship and community involvement.

Tournament Categories and Winners
The tournament featured three competitive categories: Mixed Doubles, Men's Doubles, and Women's Doubles.

Mixed Doubles
Winners: Vedant and Kalpana
Runners-Up: Nilesh and Samiya

Men's Doubles
Winners: Nilesh and Vijay
Runners-Up: Sushant and Vedant

Women's Doubles
Winners: Vedika and Kalpana



Runners-Up: Anagha and Bhakti

The matches were closely contested, showcasing impressive skill and determination from all participants.

Conclusion
The badminton tournament at the Maple Leaf Society was a remarkable event that not only promoted physical fitness but also strengthened community bonds. With lively music and a vibrant atmosphere, everyone enjoyed the experience, making it a memorable occasion for players and attendees alike. The organizers look forward to hosting more such events in the future, continuing to foster a spirit of sportsmanship within the community.





Culture and devotion shine at Kanakia Silicon Valley's Ganpati Festival



The new luxurious residential complex in Powai, Kanakia Silicon Valley, is truly buzzing with life. From the joyous "BARSO re" event celebrating the monsoon to the spirited Independence Day festivities, the residents have embraced a vibrant atmosphere of positivity and celebration. The recent Ganpati festival was no exception, infusing the community with even more energy and excitement as they came together to celebrate the festival for the very first time.

A Grand Welcome for Bappa The festivities kicked off in style on the evening of 6th September, with a grand welcome for Ganpati Ji at 5:30 pm. The air was filled with the beats of Lezim Dance and the rhythmic thundering of Dhol, as the residents enthusiastically participated in the joyous procession.



The community united in their devotion, ushering in Lord Ganesha with heartfelt prayers and vibrant celebrations, setting the perfect tone for the days ahead.

The following day, 7th September, marked the formal beginning of the Ganpati festival with the traditional Sthapana, followed by Aarti and Prasad at 11:00 am. There was an exclusive screening of a Ganesha movie for the kids in the Mini Theatre. In the evening, the younger members of the community participated in the Children's Fancy Dress Competition, delighting everyone. With mythology as the theme, the kids dazzled the audience with their creativity and enthusiasm, portraying beloved characters from Hindu lore. The day concluded with Aarti and Prasad at 8:00 pm, offering a serene close to an eventful day.



The celebrations on 8th September were equally exciting, featuring engaging activities like Stories of Ganesha and a Painting Session for children. The evening came alive with a Statewise Dress Up and a Cultural Event, where residents showcased their regional traditions through colorful costumes, singing, and dancing, making it a night to remember.

Something for Everyone Throughout the festival, there were activities that catered to every age group.

On 9th September, children enjoyed an interactive Workshop in the afternoon, while the evening was dedicated to a lively Cultural Event filled with music and dance.



The atmosphere shifted to a more spiritual note on 10th September, with a soulful Bhajan Mandali session at 10.30 pm, after a grand Mahabhog feast, where everyone shared in the joy of prasad.

As the festival drew to a close, the community prepared for an emotional goodbye. On 11th September, the final day of celebrations, the sound of Lezim Dance and Dhol echoed through the residential complex as residents bid farewell to Bappa before the Visarjan. After days of devotion, joy, and community bonding, the time had come to immerse Lord Ganesha, with the promise of welcoming him back next year.



The Ganpati celebration at Kanakia Silicon Valley was a true reflection of the community's spirit. From the devotional moments to the joyous cultural events, the festival fostered a sense of togetherness and created cherished memories for all who participated. It was not just a religious observance, but a beautiful celebration of life, culture, and unity.

Ganpati celebration in Powai



Krishnans, Nahar



Bandekars, Nahar



Sonagras, Nahar



Jains, Nahar

Ganpati celebration in Powai



Synchronicity CHS



Magnolia Utsav Samiti, Nahar



Bldg No. 22, 23 - MHADA



Bldg No. 24 - MHADA

Ganpati celebration in Powai



Symphony CHS



Hiranandanicha Maharaja



Nairs, Raheja Vihar

A spectacular celebration: Sukhkarta dukhaharta's annual aagman at Jonquille Jamaica society



The Sukhkarta's annual aagman to the Jonquille Jamaica Society in Nahar has once again proven to be a highlight of the community calendar, showcasing the most vibrant Ganotsav celebrations in Nahar Amrit Shakti. Spanning three joyful days, the festivities blended spirituality with culture, engaging residents of all ages in a series of enchanting activities.

The excitement kicked off a week before the main event with the popular "Cook with Dad" initiative. Over 34 fathers, joined by their children, whipped up delicious dishes, offering a delightful culinary experience for the crowd that eagerly moved from counter to counter. This sense of togetherness was palpable throughout the week, with children's coloring and drawing events, as well as a bhajan sabha that drew participants from across the community. Antakshari not only brought out the Phds of Bollywood & Hindi songs, but also the fighter spirit in all the teams!

One entertaining night featured a karaoke session, where attendees channeled their inner Kishore Kumar and Arijit Singh. The talent show on the second night highlighted the impressive skills of local performers, with solo dance acts, keyboardists, guitarists, and even three-minute painters captivating the audience. The Chappan Bhog prepared by residents was a treat not just for Bappa for all his devotees present.

The crescendo of the celebrations was the evening of 7th, as the stage was set ablaze with dynamic group dance performances by children and adults alike. The crowd erupted in cheers, celebrating the talent and enthusiasm that illuminated the night. The men literally lit up the stage with specially designed jackets with fairy lights! Special guests Shri Dilip Mama Lande and his son, Shri Pranav Lande, graced the event to pay their respects to Bappa and share words of inspiration with the crowd. The JJ Cultural Committee honored Mama and other contributors for their generous contributions to the festivities, underscoring the spirit of community and support that defines these celebrations.

As the festivities drew to a close, the visarjan (immersion ceremony) was marked by a large procession of residents, who bid a heartfelt farewell to Bappa. The atmosphere was a blend of gaiety and melancholy, reflecting the deep connection the community has with their traditions.

The Sukhkarta Dukhharta's aagman was not just a celebration; it was a beautiful tapestry of culture, devotion, and community spirit.

- Tonmoy Gope

'Chaitrashree' chants the hymn for Lord Ganesha



Chaitrashree Marathi Mandal, Powai, chanted the sacred Atharvashirsha hymn for Lord Ganesha 11 times during a recent gathering. Members were informed in advance to ensure a large turnout for this devotional event. Dressed in traditional attire, attendees received copies of the hymn to participate in the group recitation.

The chanting began in unison. The Atharvashirsha comes from the Atharva Veda, one of the four Vedas, and is believed to instill a stable and peaceful mind. It attributes to Lord Ganesha the role of protector of the teacher and the narrator, enveloping them with his divine presence from all directions—in air, water, fire, and earth. The hymn praises Lord Ganesha as the ruler of the universe, representing Brahma, Vishnu, and Mahesh, as well as the Sun and the Moon. He is revered as the remover of all obstacles for his devotees.

The hymn describes Lord Ganesha as having large ears and four hands, one holding a tusk and another blessing his followers. He is adorned in red clothes, holding a red flower, with a large belly. His mode of transport is the humble mouse. The hymn concludes with devotees paying their respects to Lord Ganesha with folded hands.

After the chanting, members performed the Aarti of Lord Ganesha with a puja thali, applied haldi-kumkum to the idol, and offered flowers. The celebration concluded with the distribution of modak, the deity's favorite sweet, as prasad to all attendees.

Chaitrashree Marathi Mandal, Powai, regularly organizes religious functions. The committee members—Vidya, Meenal, Rashmi, and Shaila—hold these events at the Zodiac Hall in Florentine, Powai.

- Preeti Oka

The burnout buffer



Chaarvi Athawale

Mumbai never sleeps, they say. The same can be said for Powai. In the hustle and bustle of Powai's fast-paced lifestyle, it often feels like we're constantly on the go, juggling work deadlines, family commitments, and social obligations. Amidst all this, finding time for ourselves—just to pause, breathe, and unwind—seems like a distant dream.

When was the last time you tried something new? Picked up a brush to paint your heart out on a canvas, learnt a new sport or wanted to take up a new dance form? I could not either, until recently, when I made it a point to schedule a time-out daily. A new struggle came my way: picking a hobby is one thing, sticking to it is another.

If you're in the same boat and nodding along, here are a few tips to help you make your hobby a regular part of your life:



Let's go Hobby Shopping!

Before diving headfirst into a new passion project, take a moment to reflect on your motivations. Are you looking to reduce stress, pick up something entirely new, get active or go back to something you've always enjoyed? Knowing your "why" will guide you to a hobby that not only resonates with you, but an activity you will be able to stick with in the long run. Pro tip: You can always test the waters with the trial classes offered by local studios and centres in Powai. This way you will be able to explore, without forcing yourself into a new discipline.

Schedule it like a Doctor's Appointment

Want to sleep in on Saturday? You have a doctor's appointment! Feeling extremely lazy on a balmy Sunday afternoon? You have a doctor's appointment!

Let's face it: hobbies often get sidelined because they aren't prioritized. If you treat your hobby like a must-attend meeting, you'll get better at it, and within a year, you would have mastered it. To solidify this pact between you and your newfound recreation, consider joining a community of like-minded people. Powai has many enthusiasts, be it dedicated marathon runners jogging in the wee hours of the morning, cyclists zigzagging their way through the streets, or avid shutterbugs capturing Powai Lake's sunrise in all its glory. You name the hobby, we have the group.



Conquer the Dreaded Skill Plateau

We all hit that point where progress slows down, and motivation fizzles. Instead of giving up when your hobby feels stagnant, change your environment.

Powai offers plenty of opportunities to do that, with just the right mix of urban and green. If you've been stuck in a rut with your running routine, for example, try taking a different route and swap your usual track for the scenic Heritage Garden. If you're learning a music instrument, take your practice outdoors—try strumming your guitar in one of the quieter parks of Powai. Use the surroundings to your advantage to let your creative juices flow!



At the end of it all, let your pastime be a way to enrich your life. Live these small moments to the fullest so that your hobby in the never-ending cycle of everyday, can keep all the doldrums away.

Powai embraces spirituality, fitness and charity at 12th Swami Vivekanand Run



On Sunday, September 22, 2024, Hiranandani Powai came alive with the 12th edition of the Swami Vivekanand Run, organized by the Bharat Vikas Parishad – Powai Chandivali Branch. Over 3,000 participants gathered on Central Avenue for 10K, 5K, and 2.5K runs under various categories, including 1,300 men, 1,200 women, and 500 children. The event embraced the theme "Run For A Cause," with proceeds supporting seven charities, raising over Rs. One Million.

The environmentally friendly event avoided single-use plastic, offering runners reusable glass bottles. Participants were treated to snacks, drinks, and a vibrant Happy Street Carnival, featuring food stalls, book distribution, and entertainment.

The run started with soulful music from the Hare Krishna Movement, followed by warm-up Zumba sessions. The 10K race was flagged off at 6 AM, with corporate sponsors like Union Bank and Vakrangee playing key roles. At 7 AM, the 5K run took off amidst patriotic chants, followed by the 2.5K fun run for children and families.

The award ceremony honored over 80 winners, with free hotel stays and vouchers for the top runners. The event concluded with all participants receiving finisher medals, and the carnival continuing until 10 AM.

This year's run was celebrated not only for its athletic spirit but also for its contributions to social causes and environmental awareness.

Your child's self-esteem – build it while you have time



Debika Chaudhuri

How does your child respond when they are unable to tackle a problem? Do they sulk and sit in isolation, do they get angry and scream or do they have a conversation and discuss what to do about it. How your child handles their life's problems define their self-esteem, self-worth and self-respect.

As a parent you may think you can fix your child's self-esteem, but think again. This cannot be fixed by you; however, you can enable growth of self-esteem within your child by encouraging them to operate outside their comfort zone.

When a 15-year-old prepares and wins a debate on politics, it demonstrates their understanding and maturity on discussing the topic. It builds their self-esteem. If you on the other hand write the notes for them and sit and prepare the debate with them, their self-esteem won't be developed as much as is needed. The simple reason is that deep down your child would know that it wasn't 100 percent their own effort.

False praise doesn't build self-esteem

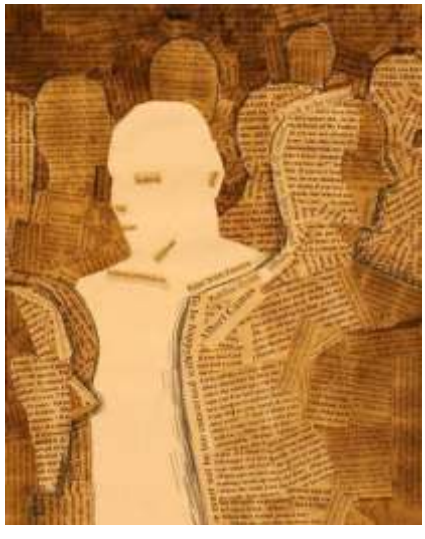
If your child has not demonstrated good time management and hasn't been able to wrap up their assignments on time, it won't build their self-esteem. Instead of challenging your child in this situation, if you decide to walk up to the teacher and blame them on their work ethics while telling your child it is okay to mess up their submissions, you won't be able to build self-esteem in your child. You will however, build false sense of ego.

Challenge excuse making habits

Your child has not made the bed for the nth time and has gone off to school. Should you decide to leave the bed unmade and show and tell your child that this habit is unacceptable and would result in cutting off some of their internet time, you would help build self-esteem over a period of time. Most often when children are used to getting things done for them, they develop the belief that they can get away with not doing it themselves. This habit erodes their self-esteem in the long term. In the real world, outside of their homes, their Managers may not be as understanding as you parents and do their tasks for them.

Teach them to deal with the problem

You child comes home and sulks and cries or just sits and begins playing games on the console. You ask how the test went and they say they've flunked it. Molly coddling your child and saying it's okay will not solve the problem. They won't learn how to navigate through difficult times in their lives going forward. They may either blame the teacher or the system or they may lull their minds and not think about it. It's necessary to empower them to think and evaluate what went right and what went wrong. How could they have gotten a different outcome? These discussions may seem tedious and boring, but they are essential for your child to develop a strong sense of self-worth and confidence as they move on in more difficult stages of life.



Limit setting

I have often heard teens going clubbing late nights or at house parties late nights and then reach home at the wee hours of the morning and I get parents question me on how much is too much. The answer lies within. It's up to you parents to decide what culture works best for you. How important are good habits for you? Are you night owls or are you the early bird? Your children watch you and decide that's the best way to operate. So I leave that answer to you. There are teens who would party late at night at the same time manage their responsibilities very well, there are those who party all night but fail to live up to the basics expectations their school and parents may have. The latter's self-esteem would falter.

Coaching your child

You may have seen coaches coaching various sports teams. When you coach your child, you begin believing in the wisdom that lies withing them. So, the language you use with your child would change. Instead of saying:
"It's simple, don't worry, you got this."
You may ask, "What are some of the blocks that you see ahead?"
"What resources would you need to overcome them?"
"How can I help you?"

As a coach to your child, always challenge the issue, it is the issue that triggers behaviors. If your child is not communicating then probably ask, "What are some of the feelings you are having now?" If the answer is "I am fine", then ask, "How does fine look like?"

However, as a coach, to ask questions you need to remember you will received pertinent answers only when your child trusts you. In many instances, children have lost trust in their parents and believe parents will be judgmental. Once trust is re-established then you may begin coaching your child.

I am an Executive Coach who enjoys working with parents and teens as well. Happy reading!

(The author, Debika Chaudhuri, runs Elzix Foundation, an Educational Consultancy for the past twelve years. She has studied across three continents and has close to three decades of experience as an Executive Educator and Career Coach. She and her team help young people make important choices at critical junctures of their lives; develop self-confidence, if they don't know what to do; help develop their skills to make the right fit; create life-changing educational experiences and help them with college admissions. She may be reached at debikac@elzixfoundation.com)

The festive buzz in Powai: A season of joy, unity, and celebration



Powai, the vibrant suburb nestled around the serene Powai Lake, turns into a hub of cultural exuberance during the festive season. As soon as the monsoons retreat, the neighborhood gears up for an action-packed lineup of celebrations—Ganpati, Navratri, Diwali, Christmas, and New Year's Eve. These festivals aren't just moments of religious significance but occasions that bring people from diverse backgrounds together in shared joy and tradition. Let's dive into how each of these festivals adds its own unique buzz to Powai.

Ganpati Bappa Morya: The Elephant God Arrives in Splendor

Ganesh Chaturthi is perhaps the grandest celebration in Powai, setting the festive tone for the months to come. Societies across Hiranandani Gardens, Raheja Vihar, and Chandivali come alive with intricately designed Ganpati pandals. You'll often see local kids running stalls, selling everything from flower garlands to eco-friendly Ganpati idols made from clay to preserve Powai Lake.

Powai Lake becomes the focal point for the Ganesh Visarjan, with thousands of devotees thronging its shores for the immersion. The lakefront is usually decorated with lights and eco-friendly immersion platforms, contributing to a cleaner, greener celebration. The streets of Powai echo with chants of "Ganpati Bappa Morya!" as processions make their way to the lake, creating an atmosphere of devotion and camaraderie.

Navratri Nights: Garba, Dandiya, and Devotion

Once Ganpati bids adieu, Powai seamlessly transitions into the vibrant festival of Navratri. Hiranandani Gardens host some of the most popular Garba and Dandiya events. One of the most anticipated events is held at Hiranandani Heritage, where professional singers and live bands belt out traditional Garba songs alongside Bollywood tunes. Residents dress in colorful chaniya cholis, kurta-pajamas, and elaborate jewelry, transforming the streets and open grounds into a kaleidoscope of color and culture. The energy is infectious, and Powai's mixed community ensures that everyone, regardless of their cultural background, feels welcome to join the revelry.

Diwali: A Festival of Lights That Illuminates the Neighborhood

The buzz around Diwali in Powai is palpable weeks before the actual festival. Hiranandani Gardens transforms into a fairyland, with every tree and building strung with glowing lights. Residents go all out, decorating their balconies with lanterns and fairy lights, while rangolis adorn the entrance of every building and home. Popular spots like Galleria Mall and Haiko Supermarket offer Diwali discounts and gift hampers, drawing large crowds in the lead-up to the festival.

Firework displays are a major attraction, and societies often collaborate to host eco-friendly cracker events, ensuring that the spirit of Diwali shines brightly but responsibly.Community get-togethers are common during this time, with neighbors exchanging sweets, gifts, and well-wishes.

Christmas Cheer and New Year Revelry: A Global Festival with a Local Heart

As the year winds down, Christmas in Powai is celebrated with a unique blend of tradition and modern festivity. The cosmopolitan crowd of Powai ensures that this global festival feels intimate and close-knit. Holy Trinity Church in Powai conducts its midnight mass, where residents, regardless of their faith, gather to celebrate the birth of Christ. Carolers from local churches visit residential complexes, filling the air with hymns and festive cheer.

Restaurants and cafes in Haiko Mall and Galleria offer Christmas brunches, complete with plum cake, and mulled wine. Local bakeries roll out special Christmas-themed goodies, which quickly become neighborhood favorites.

Powai gears up for New Year's Eve with rooftop parties, gala dinners, and fireworks. Meluha The Fern and Rodas Ecotel hotels organize extravagant New Year's Eve celebrations, offering a perfect blend of luxury and revelry. The iconic Powai Lake Promenade becomes a peaceful spot for those looking for a quiet yet scenic place to reflect on the year past, offering breathtaking views of the fireworks lighting up the sky.

Powai's Festive Spirit: A Cultural Mosaic

What sets Powai apart is how seamlessly it embraces different cultures and festivals. From the booming dhols of Ganpati to the energetic dandiya beats of Navratri, the glittering diyas of Diwali, and the jingling bells of Christmas, Powai embodies a spirit of celebration that transcends boundaries. Whether you're soaking in the tradition or dancing into the New Year, the festive buzz in Powai makes sure there's something for everyone to enjoy.

In Powai, festivals aren't just about celebration—they're about community, culture, and the joy of coming together to create lasting memories

- Anushka Bahorey
Singapore International School

Are you connected in the real sense with your breath?



Girija Menon

A tough question for me and many like me. A meditation class conducted is what kindled me to prod on this relationship. Your breath is the only thing closest to you from the moment you are born, or even before your birth. Once it leaves you, it's time for you to go.

Yet, we take it so casually as many other aspects of our life. It could be other relationships, virtues, possessions, emotions, talents, passions, etc. The list is endless.

The guruji in this particular class gave us a good rundown on emotional cleansing and how it is important. A process that ought to be undertaken at regular intervals to avoid ripples of the "not-so-good kind" seeping into our system. Emotions within each one of us are so different in texture, levels of tolerance, trigger spots, and how we emote or suppress them.

As a child emotions are released with so much ease and without any inhibitions. Simple, clean, and a clear life. Every breath the child takes is organic and they need no lessons on how to breathe. It comes with life and stays for life.

During the class, Guruji asked us to shut our eyes, which helps focus. Yes indeed, it did. With darkness, no distractions, no light, and no sound, his voice helped me, and many like me in the group look inward. Inwards onto a space that we never really bothered to look into, thanks to our busy lifestyles and commitments.

That space was dark yet in a soothing way brought about a sense of oneness. Becoming one with the heart and soul.The heartis not the physical organ that beats, whose shape, size, and texture we all know but the unseen heart that resides within that organ and its chambers. The soul doesn't even have a physical identity yet resides within every life on earth. It, I believe has a language that is unique to the individual and they regularly have conversations along the journey we call life.



Shutting our eyes and holding our breath for longer periods – starting from 30 – 40 – 50 and 60 seconds was not easy. The urge to let go or give up is so strong especially when your breath is on "pause" that when you exhale only to inhale again – it's the best feeling in the world. It's like life returns to embrace and revive you from your core.

It's at that moment that the connections happen and you become one with yourself, your breath, and your inner self. I did feel a sense of disappointment when I was unable to hold on to the last count and had to give up halfway. However, not being alone and having others in the class on the same boat gave me a bit of solace. Yet, the effort to try the next time, and hold my breath for a longer time is what I would want to do – taking tiny steps at a time.

Isn't that what LIFE is anyway? One breath at a time, one tiny step forward at a time, and one milestone at a time. A journey to complete as destined and with as much positivity as one can absorb from this beautiful universe of which we are fortunate to be part of

Life threads are the breaths that keep us afloat and alive. Let's not take it for granted because if it hits "pause" it's a reminder to you whispering "WAKE UP"

(Girija Menon, the author, enjoys her passion for writing. Her first love is poetry; an astute observer of the world around us, she loves writing down her thoughts in both poems and prose. LIFE THREADS is what she uses to weave this one-of-a-kind fabric that spans reams. She can be reached at – whisperingverses@gmail.com)



Wellness wisdom from around the world

Aloha: the spirit worth embracing



Palak Sardana

Spotlight on mental and emotional health is gradually increasing with many realizing the normalcy of seeking help. This is good news as psychological issues when addressed at personal level enhance societal health at large too. However, the bad news is that therapy is expensive and there is a dearth of trained mental health professionals to cater to this snowballing need.

Though sprucing-up education and expanding training infrastructure for producing more experts is a no brainer, it's a time consuming and resource driven endeavor. Hence, a parallel exploration of preventive measures to contain the mental health pandemic must be undertaken.

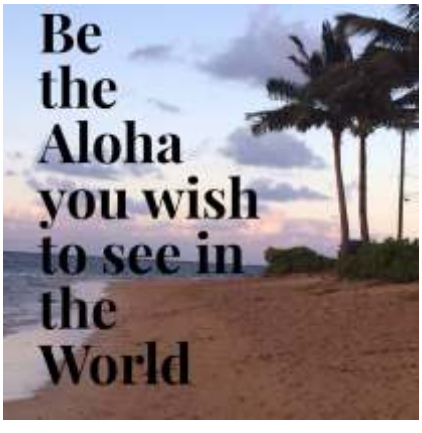
To a large extent, we are a product of our environment. We thrive in supportive and caring environments that give us a feeling of belongingness. Communities of the past were all about facilitating that environment. They embraced the spirit of mutual love and respect, give and take and acknowledging and fulfilling each other's needs with an unwritten rule of extending support and care sans exploitation. These practices weren't based on any research or data, but were intuitively drawn and practiced, eventually crystallizing as traditional wisdom that continues to be embraced by some close knit communities around the world.

With mankind's growth and advancement, this wisdom should have ideally escaped the confines of limited communities and exploded with aplomb on the world stage, uniting the planet into one family. However, despite our education and scientific leaps, we haven't been able to realize its potential. It has been marginalized as a 'cultural thing' belonging to certain communities to be experienced during a holiday or perhaps a topic of research to be turned into a documentary, a book or a ted talk.

It's like using the potential of fire only to light-up a candle.

It is high time that this wisdom is explored and integrated into main-stream. One such place to experience this wisdom in action is the US state of Hawaii. Though not high up in the list of happiest nations,' American state of Hawaii in an aberration within US. With highest happiness index in US, it also ranks high on holistic health, life expectancy and ecological balance. Besides conventional factors like job opportunities, safety etc., it is the infectious spirit of Aloha that catapults it to be the happiest US state.

Aloha essentially means mutual regard and affection for the entire ecosystem and extending warmth in care without any obligation in return. It comprises of two words, 'alo' (in the presence of) and



'ha' (the breath of life/life force). Spirit of Aloha recognizes breath to be that omnipresent element which binds every being to each other and in whose presence all life must be honored with love, kindness & care.

Aloha percolates every aspect of Hawaiian life; right from being used as a salutation, to bonding with the community, in business dealings, and in relationship with the planet. Each alphabet of aloha expands on its spirit. 'A' stands for akahai meaning kindness, 'L' is for lokahi, which means cooperating & supporting each other, 'O' is for olu olu which stands for pleasant and friendly disposition, 'H' is ha'aha'a which means humility, while the last 'A' is for ahonui which means perseverance.

Many research studies have established a direct correlation between the environment of mis-trust, discrimination and non-inclusivity with elevated psychological distress & greater likelihood of depression. The aloha spirit facilitates an environment that is in exact contrast to it and hence records the lowest depression rates in the country which is otherwise grappling with growing mental health issues.

The spirit of aloha is also extended to the sensitive eco-system of the state with considerable focus on eco-tourism. Mālama 'āina (care for the land) is unconditional regard for earth. Ocean is the biggest employer and is hence revered, while all other natural resources (animals and flora and fauna) are viewed as the intertwined elements that facilitate life.

India too has had a long standing tradition of revering natural elements with the similar idea of maintaining ecological balance. But unfortunately, over a period of time, it has been confined only to rituals and has been lost in spirit. The Hawaiians, on the other hand, have not only retained it in spirit but have also made its practice obligatory by law both for its citizens & the visitors to the island.

We don't need to rush to Hawaii to experience Aloha. What's plaguing us has its roots in Nature Deficit Disorder (NDD). We can tackle it by reconnecting, re-establishing and redefining our relationship with nature's elements, rhythms and the wisdom it so willingly imparts. We can create our own aloha sitting right where we are with what we have. No permissions, no approvals needed. Just intention and awareness.

Aloha (goodbye) for now!

(Palak Sardana is an internationally certified wellness coach, psychological counsellor, yoga teacher & founder of wellness venture, Tranquility Unlimited. Her endeavor is to present workable & practical models of wellness from ancient wisdom and modern scientific research via these articles. She runs ongoing wellness classes. For joining or booking a personalized consultation/session, write to tranquilityunlimited@gmail.com)

Dental Implants – Key to Healthy Smiles

- Dr Vaishali Prasad

Introduction: When a tooth is lost due to injury or disease, there is an inevitable bone loss. Additionally, a person can experience complications such as defective speech, shifting of teeth, increased risk of cavities and gum disease or changes in chewing patterns that result in discomfort. Replacing a lost tooth with a dental implant can significantly improve the patient's quality of life and health.

Dental implant systems consist of a dental implant body and dental implant abutment.



A dental implant body is a threaded post that replaces the root portion of a missing tooth. An abutment is an extension of this post on which an artificial tooth or crown is placed giving the look of a real tooth. Most dental implant bodies are made of titanium but some are ceramic. Both materials are safe and biocompatible.

A dental implant is the only tooth replacement option which replaces the root of the missing tooth and hence prevents further bone loss. It is the closest thing to a natural tooth. Also, it replaces the missing tooth without involving the neighbouring teeth. It's a one-tooth solution to a one-tooth problem.

Which is better, implant or bridge?

A bridge is another "fixed" option for tooth replacement. However, it requires teeth adjacent to the missing tooth to be prepared/cut to receive



crowns. Moreover, since the root portion is not being substituted for, bone loss will continue. Also, since the units are joined (it's a bridge), cleaning in between teeth and the underlying soft tissue may not be possible. Hence, while the cost of the dental bridge is initially less, the supporting "cut" teeth may become weak over a period of time and the bridge may need to be replaced at some point in the future. On the other hand, dental implants have a 90% to 95% success rate over 10+ years. In fact, with brushing, flossing and regular dental visits, implants can last a lifetime. The restoration part of the dental implant may need replacing at some point.

Other benefits of dental implants

- Better chewing ability
- Enhanced smile
- Improved speech and enunciation
- Helps keep the jawbone from shrinking due to bone loss
- Preserves the health of the surrounding bone and gums
- Helps keep adjacent (nearby) teeth stable
- Stability for wobbly dentures
- Improves quality of life

Things to consider before the dental implant procedure

- Your overall health is an important factor in determining whether you are a good candidate for dental implants, how long it will take to heal and how long the implant may stay in place.
- Smoking may affect the healing process and decrease the long-term success of the implant.
- The healing process for the implant body may take a few months, during which time you typically have a temporary abutment in place of the tooth.
- Initial healing takes about one week. But it takes anywhere from three to nine months for the jawbone to fuse around the implant – a process called osseointegration. This process stabilises the implant so it can function just like a natural tooth.
- Once the implant heals, it's safe to add the restoration – crown, bridge or denture.

After the dental implant procedure

- Carefully follow the oral hygiene instructions. Good oral hygiene maintenance is very important for long-term success of the implant.
- Schedule regular visits with your implant dentist.
- If your implant feels loose or painful, tell your dentist right away.

Replacing a Missing Tooth today will avoid grief and greater expense tomorrow &Replacement with a Dental Implant always improves your Oral Health !

(Dr Vaishali Prasad, MDSis a Pediatric& Implant Dentist practicing at Dr LH Hiranandani Hospital, Powai and can be reached at +91 7738599062 drvaishaliprasad@hotmail.com)

CORRIGENDUM

In our August 2024 issue, the headline for the article titled "DENTISTRY" was incorrectly stated as "What is Pediatric Dentistry". The correct headline should have read "The missing tooth". We apologize for any confusion this may have caused.

Foods To boost immunity



Nisha Singh

Everywhere one turns, someone is either sneezing, running a fever or fighting some kind of allergy. Well, once again the season of transition is upon us. We are officially in the Sharad Ritu or Autumn. One might think that in Mumbai we do not experience autumn. But that is not the case. Even though Mumbaikars experience more subtler weather changes than the sharp changes that are seen up North, we definitely experience a full onslaught of the allergies, cold, fever and the sneezes that come with the changes in the weather.

In this scenario, eating the right kind of foods and maintaining good lifestyle practices help in boosting one's immune system and promote good health.



● **Turmeric**: The most well-known, common, and prominently used herb in our kitchens is perhaps turmeric. Its active ingredient curcumin plays a vital role in lowering inflammation levels in the body. It is anti-microbial, anti- viral, anti-fungal, immunomodulatory, and a potent antioxidant. It also helps fight against chronic illnesses like heart disease, high cholesterol, arthritis, diabetes etc. Consume it with a dash of black pepper.



● **Ginger**: Another food that is renowned for its anti-inflammatory and immunity boosting properties, ginger contains gingerol, the potent bioactive compound that works all the magic. Research shows that long term and even low-grade inflammation can destroy the immune system's ability to function properly. Ginger juice mixed with the juice of holy basil or Tulsi and a little honey is an effective remedy for respiratory illnesses, soothing sore throat and reducing the severity of colds. Sucking on a piece of ginger coated with a little black salt helps stimulate the appetite. Ginger juice sprinkled on fruits is a great antidote to morning sickness.



● **Garlic**: Loaded with the sulfur rich compound, allicin, garlic is a staple in almost every Indian kitchen. A powerful anti-viral, anti- bacterial, and anti-fungal, garlic has been used since centuries for its medicinal properties. Research shows that garlic can help in slowing the hardening of the arteries. It also helps manage blood pressure. Allicin present in garlic boosts the activity of white blood cells. This helps in increasing the immune system's ability to fight diseases, especially cold and flu.

● **Vitamin C rich foods**: One of the most important nutrients to build one's immunity and fight against diseases like cold, flu and other infections is vitamin C. This nutrient is one of the most powerful antioxidants and it also can fight free radicals which causes damage to the cell thereby causing inflammation and disease. It also helps in the production of white blood cells. Apart from this vitamin C is also great for skin health. Fruits such lemons, amla, oranges, kiwi, sweet lime, guava, berries, pomegranate etc. are all rich sources of vitamin C as well as fiber and anthocyanins. Fiber supports gut health, and a healthy gut keeps immunity robust. Anthocyanins also help keep the immunity high, help in cognitive health as well as slow down ageing due to the fact that they are anti-inflammatory, anti-microbial and neuroprotective.



● **Probiotics**: My grandmother always said that the gut is where the health is. And more and more researches are proving just this. Almost 70% of the immune cells reside in the gut and this reinforces the fact that what we eat can directly affect our immune system. Hence, to help both our immune system and the gut its important to include a variety of probiotics such as curd, kimchi, kombucha, fermented foods like idli, pantabhaat, millet amabali etc.



Including a variety of nuts and seeds, green leafy vegetables, green tea, and herbs like mint, and holy basil, spices like cloves and black pepper and even honey, is important since they too have immunity boosting properties. Maintain a regular sleep and wake cycle, keep yourself well hydrated, sit in the sun for at least 15 minutes either in the morning or evening whenever possible. Also do not forget to include some regular meditation time in your daily routines. It is critical to follow the above suggestions as consistently as possible for a healthy immune system.

You can follow Dietitian Nisha on Instagram for nutrition & fitness tips and live interactive sessions at – nurtiwellness.by.dt.nishas

We at My Powai are now taking our reader's queries related to Diet & Nutrition, which Ms. Nisha Singh will reply to in our forthcoming issues.

You can send your questions at: dietnutrition.queries@gmail.com

(The writer is a gold medalist in Food & Nutrition with more than 12 years experience. She manages various ailments through lifestyle and dietary modifications and specializes in weight loss & management. She practices at 102, Crystal Center, Raheja Vihar, Powai or Smile Craft, 23, Annapurna Industrial estate, Opp. CCD, Ghatkopar East. For appointments: 022 2857 6537 Email: singhnisha@gmail.com)

Recipes for the festive season



Chef Ashwini Pai

With October comes the season of festivals. And in India with festivals comes good food! Durga Puja pandals serve some of the best Bengali meals in town....from crisp hot bhajas, the showstopper Bhoger khichuri to plump rosagullas.

Here's a easy recipe, with nutritious seasonal vegetables that can be whisked at home.



Image courtesy: Google

Labra Tarkari

(Serves 5-6)

Ingredients

Diced Vegetables of your choice	3 cups
Pachphoran	3 tsp
Grated ginger	2 tsp
Green chilli finely chopped	2 nos
Dry Kashmiri chilli	2 nos
Bay leaf	1 no
Turmeric	1/2 tsp
Mustard oil	3 tbsp
Bhaja Masala	2 tsp
Grated fresh coconut	1 cup
Salt To taste	

Method

Traditionally vegetables like potato, yam, cauliflower, pumpkin, brinjal, broad beans, banana stem, are used. But this recipe also tastes good with a mix of any seasonal vegetables.

Heat mustard oil till it smokes. Add bay leaf and root and vegetables that take longer to cook first. Once they are tender add beans and other greens. Add green chilli, turmeric and salt. Sprinkle water if required. Once the vegetables are cooked stir in the grated coconut. Heat ghee in a small pan. Temper panchphoran, red chilly and fry grated ginger. Add this tempering to the cooked vegetables. Sprinkle bhaja masala on top. Serve hot with khichuri, luchi or even roti.

And while at it, here's one recipe perfect for the next round of festivities. Easy to prepare, serve and delicious to eat, these vegetarian galotis will be a hit at your Diwali card patry.



Image courtesy: Google

Soya Galoti

(Makes 15-20 pieces)

Ingredients

Soya granules	3/4 cup
Ghee	4 tbsp (add oil to make it vegan)
Lazzat E Taam	1/4tsp
Ginger garlic paste	1.5 tbsp
Degimirch powder	1 tsp
Mace powder	1/8 tsp
Mint finely chopped	1 tbsp
Besan	2 tsp
Kewra water	1 tsp
Saffron	6-7 strands
Onion Thinly slices	2 cups
Oil To fry	
Salt To taste	
Water	¼ cup

Method

Soak soya granules in water for half an hour. Meanwhile fry thinly sliced onion to make Birista, golden-brown and crisp. Heat ghee in a thick bottom kadhai, saute ginger garlic paste for a few minutes, till it turns a shade darker. Add gram flour and continue to cook for a few minutes.

Mix in strained soya granules, water, salt, spice powders, saffron and kewra. Cook to evaporate water and get a dry mixture. Grind this with Birista and mint. Shape into coin sized tikkis. These can be stacked up in the fridge and seared in ghee just before the party. Add mint chutney and pickled onions on side or serve on top of coin sized parathas. Watch your guests love it.

(Chef Ashwini Pai studied culinary arts at IHM Mumbai and also has a graduate degree in microbiology. She is a recipe developer, food stylist, restaurant consultant, food and travel content writer. She believes that the best way to get to know a person or a culture is through food. Find her on instagram @ashwinipai. For details dm her on insta page @thepostcardkitchen)

October 2024



Richa Pathak

Aries (March 20 – April 18)
October brings renewed energy and opportunities for Aries individuals. Embrace positivity and seize new ventures with enthusiasm. Pay attention to your spouse's achievements, which may bring mutual success. Take time for family gatherings to strengthen bonds. Avoid stress to maintain good health. Students should focus on setting clear goals for academic progress. Remedy: Carry a small citrine crystal for positive vibes. Lucky color: Yellow. Lucky days: Wednesday & Sunday

Taurus (April 19 – May 19)
Taurus natives can expect an October filled with promising developments. Business endeavors flourish, but stay vigilant against competitors. Travel plans may arise; exercise caution during journeys. Strengthen your relationship with your spouse through open communication and shared activities. Focus on maintaining physical health with regular exercise and nutritious meals. Students should dedicate extra time to studies for academic success. Remedy: Burn lavender incense for relaxation. Lucky color: Green. Lucky days: Tuesday & Friday

Gemini (May 20 – June 20)
Professional growth and success await Gemini individuals in October. Financial prospects are favorable, but prioritize harmony in relationships. Take proactive steps towards overall well-being through regular health check-ups and balanced lifestyle choices. Career advancement demands dedication and persistence. Participate in charitable activities to invite prosperity. Remedy: Wear or carry a jade stone for good luck. Lucky color: Purple. Lucky days: Thursday & Saturday

Cancer (June 21 – July 21)
Changes in the professional sphere are likely for Cancerians this month. Manage finances wisely amidst career opportunities. Focus on your mother's health and strengthen family ties. Engage in physical activities for better health. Students should seek inspiration from spiritual places for academic success. Remedy: Light a white candle for peace and harmony. Lucky color: Silver. Lucky days: Monday & Wednesday

Leo (July 22 – August 21)
Leo individuals can expect recognition and achievements in October. Face professional challenges with determination. Take care of digestive health with a balanced diet. Enjoy quality time with family and friends for emotional support. Students should engage in community service for personal growth. Remedy: Keep a sunstone for vitality and positivity. Lucky color: Orange. Lucky days: Friday & Sunday

Virgo (August 22 – September 21)
October brings prosperity and acknowledgment for Virgo individuals in business ventures. Maintain financial stability and avoid lending money. Strengthen family bonds while addressing seasonal health concerns. Students should stay focused on academic goals. Donate to charitable causes for positive energy. Remedy: Burn sandalwood incense for relaxation. Lucky color: Pink. Lucky days: Thursday & Saturday

Libra (September 22 – October 22)
Librans may encounter professional challenges this month, but financial gains offer relief. Prioritize self-care and relaxation amidst stress. Preserve family harmony with understanding and compromise. Meditation can provide inner peace. Remedy: Carry a rose quartz for love and harmony. Lucky color: Blue. Lucky days: Monday & Friday

Scorpio (October 23 – November 20)
October brings opportunities for exploration and personal growth for Scorpio natives. Stay hydrated during travel and strengthen family bonds through quality time. Exercise caution in verbal interactions. Focus on bone health and seek medical advice if needed. Students should remain dedicated to academic pursuits. Remedy: Wear or carry an obsidian stone for protection. Lucky color: Black. Lucky days: Tuesday & Thursday

Sagittarius (November 21 – December 20)
Sagittarians can expect financial gains and personal growth in October. Manage expenses wisely and reconnect with old friends. Exercise patience in family relationships. Academic endeavors show promise with dedication. Offer water to the sun god for positivity. Remedy: Keep a turquoise stone for luck and protection. Lucky color: Yellow. Lucky days: Wednesday & Saturday

Capricorn (December 21 – January 19)
October presents lucrative opportunities for Capricorn individuals, although stress may accompany them. Prioritize relaxation and spend time with loved ones. Avoid financial risks and maintain physical well-being. Dedicate time to academic pursuits for success. Donate to charitable causes for positive vibes. Remedy: Burn jasmine incense for calmness. Lucky color: Brown. Lucky days: Sunday & Tuesday

Aquarius (January 20 – February 18)
Aquarians can anticipate professional progress and personal growth in October. Expect advancements despite temporary stress. Show patience and understanding in relationships. Take care of parental health and seek solace in spiritual practices. Participate in charitable activities for serenity. Remedy: Wear or carry a garnet stone for strength. Lucky color: Sky Blue. Lucky days: Wednesday & Saturday

Pisces (February 19 – March 19)
October brings accolades and achievements for Pisces individuals. Maintain financial stability and foster positive relationships. Resolve family disputes harmoniously. Students should focus on skill enhancement. Engage in charitable activities for fulfillment. Remedy: Light a blue candle for peace of mind. Lucky color: Aqua. Lucky days: Thursday & Sunday

(Astrologer Richa Pathak masters the art of Astrology, Vastu & Numerology. In-person consultation with prior appointment can be done at 207, Lantana, Nahar Amrit Shakti, Chandivali, Powai. She also gives Virtual Consultation & can be reached @ 8452920640 & www.jyotishdham.com)

